

RX listening — the HL2 jack vs a PC device, plus feeding digital apps.

Lyra can send received audio out two ways — pick the one that matches how your station is wired:

- **HL2 audio jack** — the headphone/speaker jack **on the Hermes Lite 2**

itself (its onboard codec, the AK4951 on HL2+). *Recommended for most operators.*

- **PC sound device** — your computer's speakers, headset, or USB audio interface (or a virtual cable to another program).

You can switch any time; Lyra remembers your choice.

Which one:

- Headphones/speakers straight into the HL2 → **HL2 audio jack**.
- Listen on the PC's speakers / a USB headset → **PC sound device**.
- Feed RX audio to WSJT-X / FLDigi / a recorder → **PC sound device via VAC, or TCI** if the app speaks it (see *Digital modes* below).

The HL2 jack is the easy button: the radio and its codec share one clock, so there's no drift to correct — glitch-free audio, lowest latency, zero setup. The PC path bridges two clocks (the HL2's and your sound card's), which Lyra handles with an adaptive resampler, but it's a little more to get right.

Where the controls are

On the **Audio panel**, top "LEVELS" row: **Out** is the output-device quick-switch — click it for a drop-down of every output (the HL2 jack is always first; the active one is marked). **Vol** is listening volume,

AF is pre-volume makeup gain (0...+40 dB, for when everything is too quiet even at full Vol), **MUTE** silences without touching Vol, and

Bal is left/right balance. **Settings** → **Audio** has the same chooser plus the Virtual Audio Cable (VAC1) options.

HL2 audio jack (onboard codec / AK4951)

1. Plug headphones or powered speakers into the **PHONES jack on the Hermes Lite 2**.
2. Click **Out** on the Audio panel and choose **HL2 audio jack** (the first entry). *(Or Settings → Audio → output device.)*
3. Bring **Vol** up; if it's still quiet, add a few dB on **AF**.

No device matching, no sample-rate fiddling — this is the default and the path we recommend unless you specifically need PC audio.

PC sound device

1. Click **Out** (or open **Settings** → **Audio**).
2. Pick your PC output — speakers, USB headset, or interface.
3. Set **Vol** to taste.

Lyra resamples between the HL2 and your sound card automatically. If your device name appears more than once (different Windows audio backends), just try one; pick another only if you hit dropouts.

Digital modes — getting RX audio to another program

A digital program (WSJT-X, JTDX, MSHV, FLDigi...) needs to *hear* the receiver. Lyra offers **two routes** — pick the one your program supports:

- **TCI** — if your program speaks TCI (e.g. **MSHV**, **SDRLogger+**), it

connects over the network and the RX audio rides that link directly. No virtual audio cable needed, and the same link carries transmit audio back the other way.

- **VAC** — for programs that expect a **sound-card input** (e.g. WSJT-X,

JTDX classic, FLDigi). Lyra plays RX audio into a virtual audio cable and the program records from it.

Which? If the app has a "TCI" radio/transport option, use TCI — least setup. If it only offers sound-card in/out, use VAC.

TCI route: Settings → Network — enable Lyra's **TCI server**, note the port. In the program, choose **TCI** and point it at Lyra's address + port. RX audio now streams over TCI (transmit goes back the same way — set the mic source to **TCI**; see **Setting up your mic input**).

VAC route: install a virtual audio cable on Windows first (e.g. VB-CABLE) — it appears as both a playback and a recording device.

1. **Settings → Audio → Virtual Audio Cable (VAC1).**
2. Tick **Enable VAC1 (RX→PC and PC→TX).**
3. **Driver** — the audio backend for the cable (default usually works).
4. **Output device** — the cable's **input side** (e.g. "CABLE Input"):
where Lyra sends RX audio.
5. Set **RX gain** so the program's level meter sits in its happy range.
6. In the program, set its **audio input** to the cable's **output side**
(e.g. "CABLE Output").

There's an option to auto-enable VAC1 when you switch to a digital mode. VAC1 also carries **PC → TX** (covered in **Setting up your mic input**).

Hearing your own transmit

On the Audio panel, **MON TX** monitors your own processed TX audio (set the level with the **Monitor** slider) so you can hear exactly what you're sending; it routes to the HL2 jack. For CW, **CW MON** sets the gateway sidetone level (separate from MON TX).

If something's wrong

- **No audio:** check **MUTE** is off and **Vol** is up; confirm the right

device under **Out** (the marked entry is active); on the HL2 jack make sure the plug is in the **radio's** jack.

- **Too quiet at full Vol:** add gain on **AF**.

- **Clicks/dropouts on a PC device:** that's the two-clock bridge under

load — try a different backend of the same device under **Out**, close heavy audio apps, or switch to the HL2 jack (which avoids it entirely).

- **One side only:** centre the **Bal** slider.

- **A digital app can't hear the radio:** **TCI** — confirm the TCI server is

on and the app is set to TCI on the right port; **VAC** — Lyra's Output device must be the cable's **input** side and the app's input the cable's

output side (a matched pair); nudge **RX gain**.
